
Subject: James Wead letter to John Steele Wead 1866
From: JSW 3 <jimmy.wead@gmail.com>
To: Jane Jolly <mjolly937@gmail.com>
Date Sent: Friday, March 27, 2026 10:12:11 AM GMT-05:00
Date Received: Friday, March 27, 2026 10:12:11 AM GMT-05:00
Attachments: James Wead letter to John Steele Wead 1866.pdf

Hi Jane,

Attached is a letter I own and cherish written by Massies Creek James Wead (b 1790) to his son John Steele Wead my 3rd Great Grandfather in 1866. After he was discharged from the civil war. I thought it being. He somehow traveled with a Stevenson (guessing neighbor)and joined the same regiment. I found this out through his obituary.

DEATH OF JOHN S. WEAD

RESPECTED CITIZEN OF PARIS
CALLED TO HIS REWARD.

DECEASED WAS NATIVE OF OHIO

Served His Country Well as a Soldier, Participating in Several of the Notable Battles of the War—Other Deaths.

John Steele Wead who died at 4:30 o'clock a. m., Wednesday at his home 502 North Central avenue, was born on a farm near Xenia, O., June 11, 1835. He was educated in the public schools of Xenia, and upon finishing the course and while still a very young man, he came to Illinois and engaged in business at Galesburg. Here he remained until about the time the civil war broke out when he removed to Coles county, and in August, 1861, at Kansas he enlisted with Co. E, 66th Ill. Vol. regiment. He was in three engagements: Mt. Zion, Mo.; Shiloh and Ft. Donelson, Tenn. At the last named place, through terrible exposure he lost his health and was soon discharged in June, 1862. John J. Stevenson of this city was in the same company.

Returning to Illinois and to Coles county, he met Miss Phebe Butler, also an Ohioan, and on Dec. 24, 1863, they were married at Charleston and came at once to Paris, where they went to housekeeping and Mr. Wead engaged again in business. Five children were born to the union, Olive Belle and Bessie Helen, who died in infancy; Dr. Scott, of Wyoming, Ill., and Misses Ella Elizabeth and Urith Lois, of this city. Just eleven months ago Mrs. Wead preceded her husband to the home beyond.

So reads the brief biography of a life, but it reveals nothing of the beauty of character which those who

know us best can see. A man devoted to home and family, most conscientious and honest in all his dealings with his fellowmen, attending strictly to his own business; in everything, dependable, gentle, kind. In short possessed of all those traits that go to make up an ideal citizen, neighbor, friend, the sort for whom no courts were ever organized.

In his religious convictions Mr. Wead was a Methodist and the funeral obsequies were in charge of Rev. M. G. Coleman.

May 31st 1866

Dear Children I Received
yours of the 6 of May and
was glad to hear from you
my Health is about as usual
I have failed considerably since
I was out to see you I am still
living at Roberts I ren-
ted my Property the 1st of April
at \$12.50 per month in ad-
vance the wheat crops in
this Country are about
it was killed in ^{the winter} winter
Robert Sowed fifty Bushels
seed we don't know whether
he will cut any or not he
may have some he can't have
40 Bushels its so far as I know
the Corn that's planted seems
to be doing pretty well the
Spring is very backward and
cold and dry

you will see in the Witness
Elizabeth James Death on the
2 of May she was sick 5 weeks
she suffered very much the
Dr didn't know what her
complaint was Mary has not
been well for several days it is
something like the Ague
you wanted ~~to~~ me to go out
this summer I intend going
if I keep my health to Warsaw
falls I want you to write soon
and let me know how you are
getting along if you have a
prospect of getting a house soon
I guess I will close

Your Father James Dead
To John, S. & Phoebe Dead